Neon Fallout Sign



by Crow Builds

This tutorial will show you how to make a cool neon sign. You can do any shape, design or words you can think of. You could even do it in multiple colours.

I chose to do a Fallout themed neon sign in a light blue.

Supplies:

Materials:

- El wire - you can get this from ebay or amazon. Just search "el wire", "LED rope" or "LED flex" - keep in mind it is not an LED light but some sellers list it that way. It cost me about $4 for 5 meters. They come in a variety of colours and sizes. I used 5 meters but 6 meters would've been better. IT depends on your design.
- Hot glue
- A back board - I used 4 x pieces of pallet timber

Tools:

- Hot glue gun
- Drill with small drill bit
- Screwdriver and screws - to join the pallet wood. Not needed of your using one large piece of plywood.

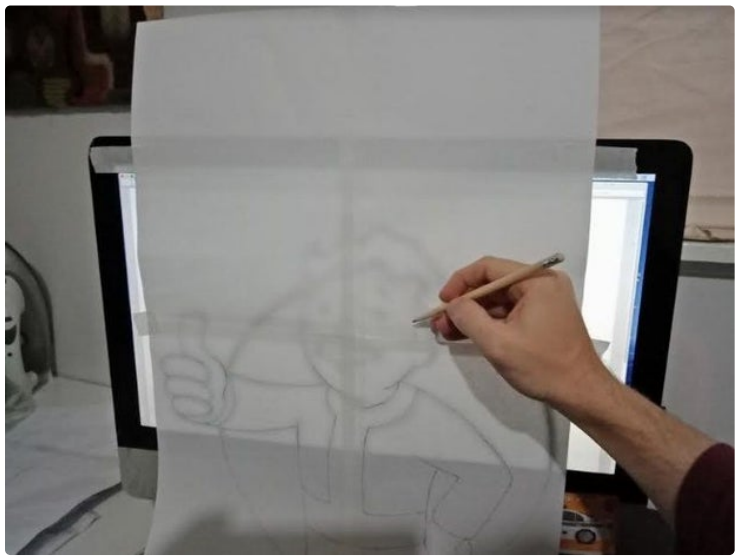






Step 1: Print or Trace Your Design

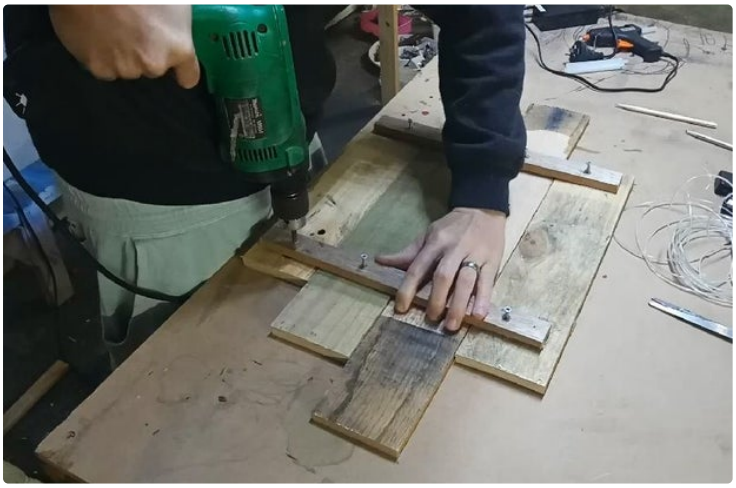
Find a cool design and either print it or trace it if you don't have any printer ink like me ;)



Step 2: Prepare Your Backboard

I used 4 pieces of pallet timber and joined them by screwing them into 2 smaller pieces of wood as shown in the picture above.

You can use anything as a backboard instead such as plywood, mdf, etc.

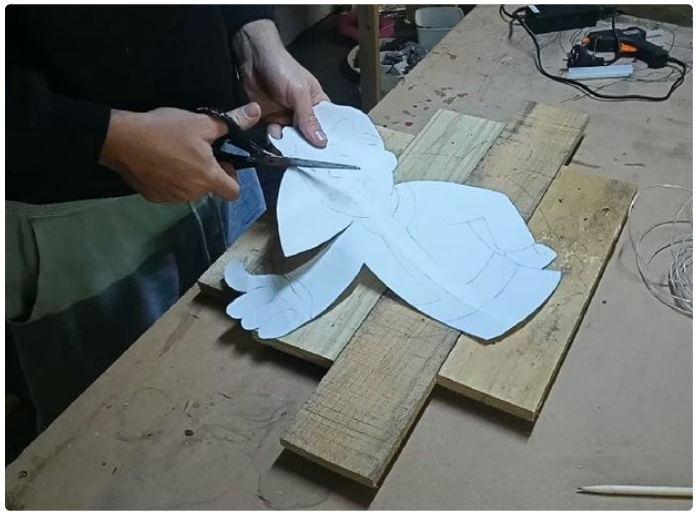


Step 3: Trace Your Design Onto the Backboard

Cut out your design and trace around it onto your backboard. Keep cutting and tracing until your whole design has been transferred onto the wood.





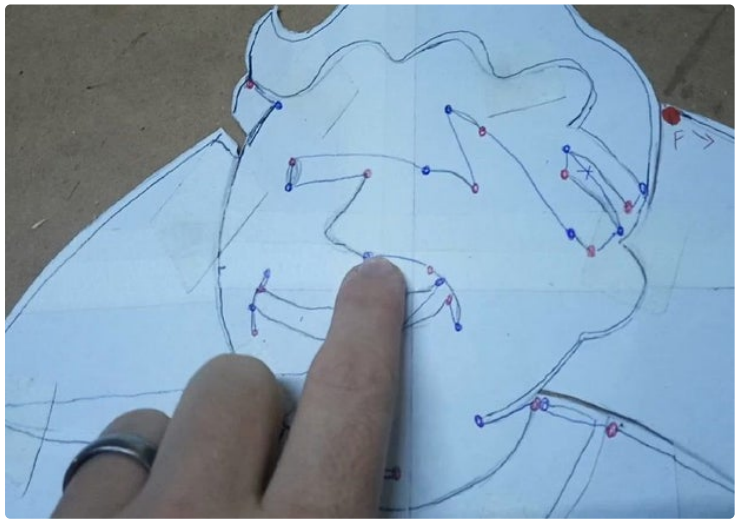




Step 4: Plan Where the LED Rope Will Be Threaded

Depending on your design, you need to plan where you will be threading and gluing your El wire.

As it comes in one continuous length, draw your design on a spare piece of paper with one continuous line. Decide where you will need to drill holes as you may need to reach areas of the design which aren't connected to any other lines. for this, you will want your rope to be hidden behind the board and then visible again just for those specific lines. Referring to the next steps will make more sense.



Step 5: Drill the Holes

Referring to your plan, drill out all of the holes where the El wire will be threaded through.





Step 6: Start Threading and Gluing

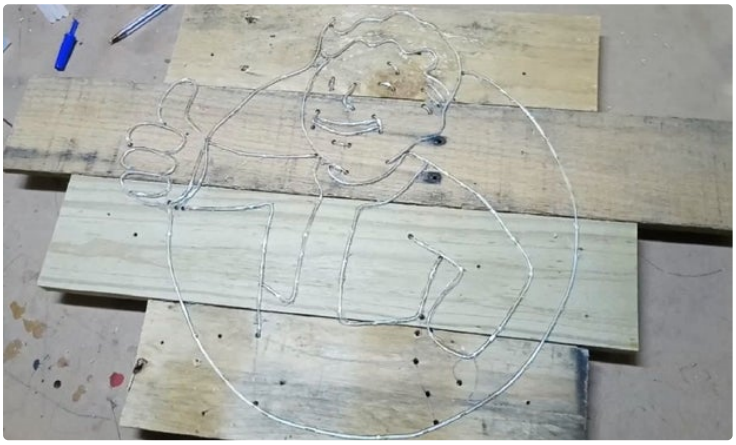
Thread the El wire through your starting hole and start to glue it down along your design lined that you drew on. If you need to jump to a separate line, thread it down through a hole and back up again at the start of the new line. Continue until your design is complete.











Step 7: Hang on the Wall

Hot glue the battery pack and switch somewhere on the back edge then you're all set to hang the sign on the wall.

Well done and enjoy your new neon wall sign.

Thanks again.

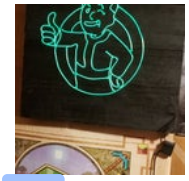




Very nice! I'm going to give this a try!



Mine isn't quite as big. But 5 meters was plenty





Looks really great. Where did you got the Fallout Logo from? Could not find any suitable logo but would be great if you can share yours.
Thanks

i used this pic: https://images.app.goo.gl/JazBW6sdALyJkL9K9



The template I used.



That is so cool!! Good work!

also another tip.. i re-enforced the whole thing with super glue as hot glue had trouble holding some parts. Maybe i'll edit that part in.

Could you give a link or search term for the LED strip? I can't find it on Amazon or EBay.

Hey sorry i had it wrong It's called "el wire" try searching that

Thank you!

I do not know for sure, but I am assuming the author used “El Wire”. You can find from many sources including amazon. Here is what I think is same as what author used: Lychee Neon Light El Wire with Battery Pack, 15 Feet, Blue https://www.amazon.com/dp/B00EENNHMM/ref=cm_sw_r_cp_api_i_SQ1nDbAREHHZ8

Wonderful! Thank you for that.

Nice work! I was told that the wire you used has a limited operating life?

Since you confirm these are EL wires, please fix the instructable... EL wire is not LED
Regarding the instructable, thank you. I have an EL wire string and now I know what I can do with it ;)

Great job, love el-wire.

Can you share a link to the LED strip that you used?

Hey sorry i had it wrong. It's called "el wire" try searching that

Ahoy! Nice project, but no need to confuse visitors. This is not LED rope. There is nothing to do with LED technology. It's called EL wire or electroluminescent wire and works with other principles than LED.

You are absolutely right. It was the first time i came across this stuff and the ebay seller had it listed as led rope. Thanks for the info and i'll update the post for future viewers :)

EL Wire https://www.amazon.de/dp/B013HTLW8E/ref=cm_sw_r_cp_apa_i_VaZnDbMNJWMT6

I didn't know it was LED... It looked so smooth!

I really love the simple wood background with the LED lighting :)

Thank you :)